

STAGE TEN • RELATIONSHIPS & CONNECTIONS

FIRSTS

ADAPTATION NOTES

Online vs. in-person format notes for every activity that changes shape

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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PURPOSE

Stage Ten's activities lean more heavily on genuine personal disclosure and trust than most other stages, which makes format genuinely consequential here. A few activities, most notably the trust-building exercise, work meaningfully better in person; this document says so honestly rather than pretending every format is equivalent.

This document covers every activity across Stage Ten's Session Plan and Group Versions of Key Exercises documents that genuinely changes shape between formats.

Format Notes by Activity

Activity	In-Person	Online
Origin Story / small-group sharing (icebreakers)	Small clusters of chairs, genuine face-to-face eye contact for personal sharing.	Breakout rooms of 2-3, cameras on if participants are comfortable. Personal sharing tends to feel more natural on video than in a large-group chat format.
Role-Reversal Rehearsal (FIRST N4, from Group Versions doc)	Pairs turn to face each other directly; easier to read body language and tone.	Breakout rooms of 2. Since tone is harder to read on video, encourage participants to actually say the words out loud rather than just describing what they'd say.
Graduated Disclosure Circle (FIRST N9)	Small circles of chairs, genuine physical presence supports the vulnerability this exercise asks for.	This genuinely works better in person. If run online, keep it to breakout rooms of people who already know each other well, and make the opt-out explicitly easy ("pass" is always a fine answer).
Silent Alignment Check (FIRST N13)	Physical index cards flipped simultaneously.	Use a shared form or poll that reveals answers only once everyone has submitted, not a chat message (which is visible as it's typed and biases later answers).
Structured Pair Problem-Solve (FIRST N14)	Pairs face each other; a visible timer helps enforce the uninterrupted-explanation structure.	Breakout rooms of 2. Post the timing structure (2 min each, uninterrupted) in the breakout room instructions since there's no facilitator physically visible to help pace it.
Specific Shoutout Round (FIRST N19)	Genuine round-robin around a table.	Works naturally well online since everyone is already visible; use "raise hand" to keep the order clear rather than open-floor.
Question Workshop (FIRST N23)	Pairs read questions aloud to each other directly.	Breakout rooms of 2. Consider having Partner B type their honest "generic or tailored?" rating in chat first before saying it aloud, to avoid softening real feedback out of politeness.
Full-group share-outs / closing rounds	Genuine round-robin around the room.	Use "raise hand" or call names directly from a list rather than open-floor, which tends to stall on video.

GENERAL HYBRID GUIDANCE

For any activity involving genuine personal disclosure (trust-building, conflict rehearsal), a hybrid format should never mix in-person and remote participants in the same small group — the different levels of presence create a real, uneven dynamic. Keep remote participants together in their own breakout rooms for these specific activities.

For full-group discussion of sensitive topics, make the opt-out explicitly easy in both formats: a simple “pass” in person, and a chat-based way to signal “skip me” online without needing to unmute and explain why.